

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, RAIPUR REGION

FIRST PRE - BOARD EXAM (2025-26)

Subject: - English Communicative (Sub code 101)

Class: X

Time: 03 Hrs

Max Marks: 80

General instructions:

- All questions are compulsory
- Marks are indicated against each question
- Reading time allotted to you is 15 minutes
- Attempt all the question in each section before going to the next section
- Read each question carefully and follow the instructions as directed
- Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

S.No	Section A - Reading Comprehension	22 Mks
Q1.	Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.	12M
	Over the last two decades, India has been undergoing a quiet transformation—one not always captured by glossy images of skyscrapers or metros. This change is taking place in villages, where nearly 65 percent of the population still resides. Rural India, often stereotyped as stagnant, has been steadily reshaping itself in terms of economy, education, and aspirations.	
	The first and perhaps most significant change has been the diversification of income sources. Traditionally, agriculture was the backbone of rural livelihoods. Even today, it employs a large number of people. However, with unpredictable monsoons, limited land, and rising cultivation costs, many families have sought alternative means of income. A rise in rural entrepreneurship is visible: from grocery shops to food-processing units, tailoring businesses, and digital service centers. This reflects not only resilience but also the willingness to embrace new opportunities	
	Education has played a pivotal role in this transformation. Earlier, sending children to school, particularly girls, was considered unnecessary. But government initiatives like the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, mid-day meal schemes, and scholarships encouraged parents to prioritize education. A	

	new generation is not only completing school but also aspiring for higher studies. Many are the first in their families to attend college, breaking barriers of caste, gender, and tradition. Education has broadened their outlook, given them confidence, and enabled them to dream of careers beyond agriculture or crafts.	
	Technology, too, has been a great enabler. Mobile phones, once considered a luxury, are now indispensable in rural households. Smartphones and affordable internet have connected villages to the wider world. Farmers can check weather forecasts, learn modern farming techniques, and even sell their produce online. Young villagers, who once felt cut off from city life, are now as updated with global trends as their urban counterparts. In some areas, women run small businesses entirely through WhatsApp groups, selling handicrafts, pickles, or handloom products.	
	Migration has also contributed to this transformation. Many young men and women migrate seasonally or permanently to cities in search of jobs. The remittances they send home support their families and improve village life. Houses are being rebuilt with better facilities, children attend private schools, and healthcare is sought in towns. However, migration has also led to challenges. Villages witness aging populations as the youth leave. Moreover, the traditional sense of community bonding is weakening as families become nuclear.	
	Health and sanitation have shown gradual progress, though issues remain. The government's Swachh Bharat Abhiyan created awareness about cleanliness. Many villages built toilets, reducing open defecation. Access to clean water has improved, though in drought-prone areas, scarcity still dictates routines. Healthcare facilities remain inadequate in remote regions, forcing people to travel long distances. Yet, compared to even fifteen years ago, there is growing recognition of the importance of health and hygiene.	
	Culturally, rural India has not abandoned its roots. Festivals, folk music, dances, and traditional crafts still thrive, even as they adapt to modern influences. Television and social media have introduced new fashions, but villagers often blend these with tradition. Weddings now combine modern music with folk songs, or designer outfits with handwoven fabrics. This balance reflects a community that values heritage while welcoming change.	
	Environmental concerns, however, are emerging. Overuse of chemical fertilizers, deforestation, and groundwater depletion threaten rural sustainability. Climate change, leading to erratic rainfall, is a constant worry for farmers. Encouragingly, some villages are turning to organic farming,	

Q2.	Read& Analyse the passage and answer the questions that follow.	10 M																																
	Changing Lifestyles of Indian Teenagers (Survey 2024) The following information is based on a national survey conducted among 5,000 teenagers (ages 13-19) in both rural and urban India. It highlights how their time, habits, and priorities are changing in the digital era. <table><tr><th>Activity</th><th>Rural Teenagers (hrs)</th><th>Urban Teenagers (hrs)</th><th>National Average (hrs)</th></tr><tr><td>School/College Studies</td><td>4.5</td><td>5.0</td><td>4.7</td></tr><tr><td>Homework/Extra Classes</td><td>1.5</td><td>2.5</td><td>2.0</td></tr><tr><td>Screen Entertainment (TV/OTT/Gaming)</td><td>2.0</td><td>3.8</td><td>2.9</td></tr><tr><td>Social Media& Messaging</td><td>1.5</td><td>2.7</td><td>2.1</td></tr><tr><td>Household Chores/Work</td><td>2.2</td><td>1.2</td><td>1.7</td></tr><tr><td>Physical Activities/Sports</td><td>1.8</td><td>1.0</td><td>1.4</td></tr><tr><td>Sleep</td><td>10.0</td><td>8.5</td><td>9.2</td></tr></table> The table shows striking differences between rural and urban teenage lifestyles. Rural students spend slightly less time on formal education but more on household chores. Urban teenagers spend far more hours on screens—especially entertainment and social media.	Activity	Rural Teenagers (hrs)	Urban Teenagers (hrs)	National Average (hrs)	School/College Studies	4.5	5.0	4.7	Homework/Extra Classes	1.5	2.5	2.0	Screen Entertainment (TV/OTT/Gaming)	2.0	3.8	2.9	Social Media& Messaging	1.5	2.7	2.1	Household Chores/Work	2.2	1.2	1.7	Physical Activities/Sports	1.8	1.0	1.4	Sleep	10.0	8.5	9.2	
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	Education remains a central part of daily life. On average, students devote nearly 6.7 hours (class + homework) to academics. However, the national average for screen-related activities (OTT, gaming, social media) is also very high at 5 hours daily, nearly rivaling time spent on studies. This dual focus reflects the attraction of digital life alongside academic pressure.																																	
	Physical activity is another area of concern. Rural youth, often engaged in outdoor work, spend more time in physical activities compared to urban teenagers, who average only about 1 hour daily. Experts suggest that this lack of movement may contribute to rising obesity and lifestyle-related health problems among city-based adolescents.																																	
	Interestingly, rural teenagers sleep more (10 hours) compared to urban youth (8.5 hours). Researchers interpret this as both a cultural and environmental factor—urban teenagers often stay up late on devices, while rural youth follow earlier routines.																																	

	Parents participating in the survey expressed mixed feelings. They appreciate that digital access allows children to learn, explore hobbies, and stay connected. At the same time, they worry about reduced physical fitness, late-night screen use, and the impact on face-to-face family interaction.	
	Experts conclude that the teenage lifestyle is undergoing rapid change. Education is still valued, but digital habits strongly shape routines. If balanced, these habits can enhance creativity and learning. If unchecked, however, they may lead to health and social challenges. The study calls for a “digital balance” where teenagers use technology as a tool rather than become dependent on it.	
1.	Which activity shows the greatest difference in time between rural and urban teenagers? a) Sleep b) Homework/Extra classes c) Screen entertainment d) Physical activities	1
2.	Mention one parental concern about teenage digital habits. a) Increased homework efficiency b) Reduced physical fitness c) Improved creativity d) Better global awareness	1
3.	What solution do experts suggest for teenage digital habits? a) Complete ban on digital devices b) Digital balance c) Increase in screen time for academics d) More social media interaction	1
4.	Find the synonym of the word “unchecked” (used in the last paragraph). a) Restricted b) Controlled c) Uncontrolled d) Balanced	1
5.	Rural teenagers spend more time on _____ compared to urban teenagers because rural families rely more on shared domestic responsibilities.	1
6.	What does the data suggest about the lifestyle priorities of urban teenagers compared to rural teenagers?	1
7.	What inference can be drawn from the differences in sleep patterns of teenagers of both types?	2
8.	Why do experts describe digital habits as both beneficial and risky?	2
	Section B - Writing Skills	22 M
Q3.	You are a student of PM ShriKendriya Vidyalaya, GCF No.1 Jabalpur Cantt. Write an application to the Principal requesting permission to use the school playground after school hours.	3

Q4.	Your school recently organized a Science Exhibition in which students displayed working models, charts, and innovative projects. Write a factual description of the event in about 100-120 words. You may use the following cues: 1. Date and venue of the exhibition 2. Inauguration / Chief Guest 3. Number and type of exhibits 4. Special attractions / innovative ideas 5. Response of students and visitors	4
Q5.	The recent reports in the newspapers about the growing incidence of bullying in schools have greatly disturbed you. Write a letter to the Editor of a local daily in not more than 120 words, expressing your views on this problem and suggesting ways to solve it. You are Mithun/Maithili of class X C, Vivekananda Public School, Jodhpur. You can take ideas from your M.C.B unit on 'Education'	7
	OR	
	You are awaiting your class X result. Meanwhile you would like to do a Short-term Course in Computer Graphics. Write a letter to the Director, Institute of Higher Learning, Hyderabad, in not more than 120 words, inquiring about the details of the course. You are Kiran/Keerthana, a resident of 12 M.G.Road Vijayawada.	
Q6.	In recent years, we witnessed the outcome of horrific landslides in many parts of our country, which took over hundreds of lives. You feel that most of the natural disasters are manmade. Based on your observation, write an article, in about 150 words, as Surabhi Krishna/Sourabh Krishna, of Netaji Road, Jharkand advocating for 'Sustainable Development'. You can use points from the M.C.B. Unit on 'Environment', your own ideas and the following hints: • Planning development models for ecologically sensitive areas • Climatic change • Ensuring popular support for development and conservation • Declaring such places as ecologically sensitive areas • Analysing the reason for lack of support from the local communities • Banning destructive activities such as mining, quarrying, building projects etc. in such fragile areas.	8
	OR	

	Recently during the fag end of Nava Kerala Sadas, the Government of Kerala has decided to bring out millet-based parotta and other food products to promote healthy eating. The recipe has been prepared by nutritionists at the Indian Institute of Millet Research Centre, Hyderabad. Subsequently the officials in the Agricultural Department has thought of setting up permanent millet cafes in all 14 districts. Prepare an article in about 150 words, for popularization of the programme so that people can devour many food items of their choice without having any guilt pangs and can lead a healthy way of living. You can use points from M.C.B. Unit on 'Health and Medicine', your own ideas and the following hints: • The United Nations had recognized 2023 as the International Year of Millets • Health and nutritional benefits. • Quality and taste of millet products are good. • Campaign against parotta made of maida. • Other attractive items on the menu (For example, biriyani made of millets) • Breakfast, lunch and snacks made out of millet.																
	Section C - Grammar	10 M															
Q7.	Fill in the blanks (i-iii) with the appropriate option from those in the brackets. Not a single ball was (i) ----- (bowl/bowling/bowled/being bowled) on day three (ii) -----(in/of/off/on) the Ranji Trophy Elite Group C match between Karnataka and Kerala at the Alur Grounds on Sunday after overnight and early morning rain (iii) ----- (render/renders/rendering/rendered) the outfield unplayable.	3															
Q8.	The following paragraph has not been edited. There is one error in each line .Write the error and its correction as shown in the example: <table> <thead> <tr> <th></th><th>Error</th><th>Correction</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>The students was excited for the picnic.</td><td>Was</td><td>Were</td></tr> <tr> <td>They has been planning it since a week</td><td>a _____</td><td>_____</td></tr> <tr> <td>Everyone bring their lunch from home.</td><td>b _____</td><td>_____</td></tr> <tr> <td>The teacher tell them to be careful near the river.</td><td>c _____</td><td>_____</td></tr> </tbody> </table>		Error	Correction	The students was excited for the picnic.	Was	Were	They has been planning it since a week	a _____	_____	Everyone bring their lunch from home.	b _____	_____	The teacher tell them to be careful near the river.	c _____	_____	4
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	The bus were waiting outside the school gate. d _____	
Q9i.	Rearrange the following words to make a meaningful sentence. Social/very/prevalent/world/the/around/is/injustice	1
ii.	Report the dialogues to complete the paragraph that follows. Teacher: "Rahul, have you completed your homework?" Rahul: "Yes, ma'am, I finished it yesterday." Teacher: "That's great! Can you show it to me?" The teacher asked Rahul _____ (1) his homework. Rahul replied that _____(2)	2
	Section D - Literature Reader	26 M
Q10	Read the given excerpts and attempt ANY TWO , by answering the questions that follow.	4+4
A.	<i>He holds him with his skinny hand, ‘There was a ship,’ quoth he, hold off! Unhand me, grey-beard loon! Eftsoons his hand dropt he.</i> (i) Why does the mariner use physical force to hold on to that person? (a) he is very strong (b) he likes the wedding-guest (c) the wedding-guest does not wish to be detained (d) He wants to impress him (ii) Explain the reaction of the other speaker. What is the reason of his anger? (a) he hates the mariner (b) mariner is very dirty and shabby (c) he is desperate to attend the wedding (d) he is tired (iii) Point out an archaic word from the above stanza. (iv) Explain ‘grey-beard loon’.	

B.	<i>Victoria : Are we pinching it before Aunt Elizabeth comes?</i> <i>Henry : (Shocked) No, my child. Grandpa gave it to your mother before he died.</i> (i) Victoria's remarks reflect upon the behaviour of the adults that they are (a) hypocrites (b) mercenary (c) greed-driven (d) clever (ii) Henry proves to be _____ from this statement. (a) submissive (b) gullible (c) hen-pecked(d) vulnerable (iii) What qualities of Victoria are portrayed in these lines? (iv) What was the object that Slaters were talking about in these lines?	
C.	<i>I suddenly saw the photograph that went with the story, and gasped. The boy in the picture was Sebastian. There was no doubt. "But how?" I muttered.</i> <i>Sebastian Shultz, the boy I'd got to know so well recently, had apparently been in a coma for all that time. I felt nervous and shivery. It didn't make any sense at all. I stared out of the train window, and ran through the events in my head.</i> (i)Who is 'I'? (ii)Whose photograph did he see? (iii)Find a word in the given extract which means the same as " catch one's breath with an open mouth, owing to pain or astonishment " (iv)What had happened to him?	
Q11.	Answer ANY FIVE out of the following six questions given below in about 40 words.	10
1.	How did the frog become the unrivalled king of the bog again?	
2.	Explain in your words how his 'poetry' has been glorified by the poet, in the poem, 'Not Marble, Nor the Gilded Monuments.'	
3.	What is the difference between the snake's movement at the beginning of the poem and later when the poet strikes it with a log of wood?	
4.	Bring out the similarities in the characters of Mrs Packletide and Loona Bimberton.	
5.	How does Patol Babu reconcile to the dialogue given to him ?	
6.	Why is the ghost fed up of the Ouija Board fanatics?	
Q12.	Answer ANY ONE out of the following two questions given below in about 150 words.	8

1.	Antony's funeral speech changes the mood of the people completely. How does he manage to influence and convince the crowd? Explain (Julius Caesar)	
2.	Ali waits for five long years at the post office for a letter from his daughter, yet he never receives it in his lifetime. Do you think his patience and hope make him a weak character or a strong one? Justify your answer with reference to the story	